princes demurred. Disgusted by how low nobility had fallen, Yaqut Khan decided that such a faithless world was not for him. He retired to his haveli within the fort to bathe, pray in his mosque, and prepare his shroud. Having set his worldly affairs in order, Yaqut Khan swallowed a large quantity of opium and lay down to die.

In January 1601, after a debilitating siege of ten months, the keys of the fort were finally handed over to Akbar, and Bahadur Shah was imprisoned and sent with his family to Gwalior Fort, to join the young Nizam Shah of Ahmadnagar while all the other officers and soldiers were pardoned. Daniyal was received at Ahmadnagar in April 1601 and was given the kingdom of Khandesh, which was renamed Dandesh in his honour. The Deccan plateau would become the base for the subsequent thrust of the Mughals into the south. But that would be a task for Akbar's descendants, for the Padshah himself had more pressing and personal problems to attend to. The enemy, it transpired, had been nurtured in the very heart of the empire. Away in the north, in the city of Allahabad, Shaikhu Baba had pronounced himself Shah Salim, an incendiary and most traitorous claim.

*Supply depots.